

# H5 Data Centers: a February meeting with next steps still open

Partner activation plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo

|                                                             |                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Feb 20</b><br>meeting with AJ Steller                    | <b>2</b><br>open next steps (KMZ, preliminary design)                               | <b>~195</b><br>employees                                                                                                                       | <b>0</b><br>joint deals logged                                                                 |
| <b>STAGE</b><br>Partner: engaged in February, then stalled. | <b>RUNNING NOW</b><br>CTF PARTNER - Warm Network (draft): Hannah Dawson, AJ Steller | <b>LAST TOUCH</b><br>Feb 20: meeting recap (next steps: KMZ, preliminary design, loop in Rabin at H5); one LinkedIn message to Rabin, no reply | <b>NEXT STEP</b><br>Mon Oct 5: email AJ Steller with the KMZ and ask for a warm intro to Rabin |

## Bottom line

H5 Data Centers (Colorado, about 195 people) is developing in Chicago. On **Feb 17-20 you met AJ Steller (Director of Interconnection Strategy)** about H5's Chicago development: vision, timelines, power and proximity to network hubs. The agreed **next steps were to share the KMZ, start a preliminary design based on its point-of-entry details, and loop in Rabin** on H5's side, who is tied to the go-to-market launch of H5's Chicago data center near our network. One LinkedIn message to Rabin went unanswered. Go through AJ for the introduction. Nothing has been logged since. **This is the warmest data center thread on your list**; restart it with the deliverable, not a check-in.

## What H5 is, in one analogy

H5 is building a new house and already asked to see our plumbing plan. We owe them the drawing.

## Signals worth citing

| Signal                                                                              | Source                 | So what for the opener                                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Feb 17-20 meeting: H5 Chicago development, timelines, power, network proximity      | HubSpot                | Engaged partner.                                        |
| Next steps: KMZ, preliminary design from point-of-entry details, loop in Rabin (H5) | HubSpot (Feb 20 recap) | Open commitments; Rabin tied to the Chicago GTM launch. |
| H5 exec on Colorado's data center power and tax challenges (Sep 6)                  | ZoomInfo scoop         | Context.                                                |

## Work already in motion

Engaged in February, then quiet.

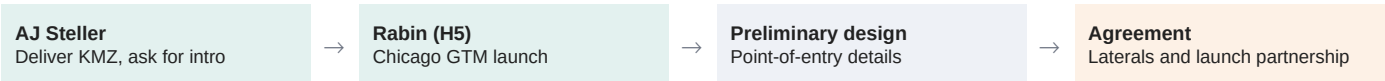
| When      | Channel / campaign | What happened                                                  | Read              |
|-----------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Feb 16    | HubSpot            | Jenna Baker inbound                                            | -                 |
| Feb 17-20 | Meeting            | "Crosstown Fiber at H5 Data Centers - Chicago" with AJ Steller | Next steps agreed |
| Sep 30    | Lemlist draft      | CTF PARTNER - Warm Network: Hannah Dawson, AJ Steller          | Not launched      |
| Since Feb | LinkedIn           | One message to Rabin (H5)                                      | No reply          |

## Who to reach, in order

| Contact       | Title (source)                                          | Where | Why they matter                                          | Status / email                                        |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| AJ Steller    | Director of Interconnection Strategy (HubSpot)          | n/a   | Owner of the thread.                                     | Met Feb 20                                            |
| Rabin         | H5, Chicago data center go-to-market (title to confirm) | n/a   | Shapes the Chicago launch and its connectivity partners. | 1 LinkedIn message, no reply; get a warm intro via AJ |
| Hannah Dawson | Sales Director (HubSpot)                                | n/a   | Sales.                                                   | Warm draft                                            |
| Jenna Baker   | (HubSpot)                                               | n/a   | Original inbound.                                        | Feb 16                                                |

## Not worth chasing for this goal

## How the access path should run



## Messages, by contact

### 1. AJ Steller Director of Interconnection Strategy

*Why them: We owe him the deliverables.*

**Channel: Email Mon Oct 5 (personal, with KMZ attached) | Subject: KMZ and preliminary design for H5 Chicago**

AJ, as promised in February, here's our Chicago KMZ. I'd like to keep the preliminary design moving for H5 Chicago's point of entry, and I'd value 30 minutes with Rabin on the go-to-market plan for the launch, since our routes sit right next to the site. Could you make that introduction? Happy to walk the site with you both.

## The plan

| When           | Move                                                                                  | Notes     |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Fri Oct 2      | Pull the KMZ; confirm Rabin's title and role on LinkedIn.                             | Internal. |
| Mon Oct 5      | Email AJ with the KMZ; ask for the Rabin intro.                                       | -         |
| Thu Oct 8      | If no intro, call AJ; second, value-led LinkedIn note to Rabin (launch connectivity). | -         |
| Week of Oct 19 | Meeting with AJ and Rabin: launch plan, point of entry, joint GTM.                    | -         |
| Nov            | Preliminary design and launch-partner proposal.                                       | -         |

## What progress looks like (for management)

| By     | Milestone               | How we will know |
|--------|-------------------------|------------------|
| Oct 9  | KMZ delivered           | Email logged     |
| Oct 23 | Meeting with Rabin held | Meeting logged   |
| Dec 15 | Proposal sent           | Deal created     |

## Guardrails

- Go through AJ for Rabin; a second cold message without an intro is the fallback, not the plan.
- Credits used: ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

## Sources

HubSpot email history (Feb 16-20) and contacts; Lemlist draft; ZoomInfo scoops.